Joseph A. Smith

Wastewater & Public Works Operations | Pump Systems & Lift Stations | Field Supervision

Norton Shores, MI | (231) 329-4858 | nvirogear1@gmail.com | josephsmith.info (in setup) — Target: Grand Haven Charter Township - Public Services / Water & Wastewater Operations Supervisor

PROFILE

Field operations supervisor candidate for Grand Haven Charter Township: two and a half years as an environmental/wastewater field technician through Fleis & VandenBrink on the Zephyr remediation site, checking lift stations, pumps and controls, collecting and documenting samples, and keeping field work inside permit lines. Ran a tree service for five-plus years and led commercial construction crews. HAZWOPER 40, Industrial Stormwater, UST Inspection and Respiratory Protection certified; CDL eligible for renewal. GIS-based reporting is a supporting tool here, not the headline.

OPERATIONS STRENGTHS

Wastewater Operations & Lift Stations | Pump Systems & Preventive Maintenance | Field Maintenance & Repair | Safety & Regulatory Compliance (HAZWOPER, Stormwater, UST) | Commercial Construction Crew Leadership | Mechanical & Electrical Troubleshooting | Field Documentation & Reporting | Diesel & Heavy Equipment | Sample Collection & Monitoring | GIS & Records Support

CERTIFICATIONS & QUALIFICATIONS

OSHA / HAZWOPER 40-Hour — Completed
Industrial Stormwater Certification — Completed
Underground Storage Tank Inspection Certification — Completed
Respiratory Protection / PPE Certification — Completed
CDL — Eligible for renewal

FIELD & OPERATIONS EXPERIENCE

Environmental / Wastewater Field Technician

Fleis & VandenBrink — 2.5 years, assigned to the Zephyr remediation site, Muskegon

- Performed environmental and wastewater field work at the Zephyr remediation site under Fleis & VandenBrink, one of the larger sediment and groundwater remediation efforts in Muskegon County.
- Collected and documented environmental samples and monitoring data with chain-of-custody discipline; field notes that hold up to agency and client review.
- Inspected and checked lift stations, pumps and related infrastructure; identified mechanical and electrical faults and escalated or repaired within scope.
- Read project drawings and specifications; coordinated daily field operations with engineers and site staff.
- Kept field work inside permit and safety lines, applying HAZWOPER 40-hour and stormwater training on site.

Owner / Operator - Arborist & Tree Climbing Services

Self-employed — 5+ years

- Ran all aspects of a tree service business: estimating, scheduling, crew supervision, equipment maintenance, safety, customer communication.
- Climbed and rigged removals and prunings around structures and utilities; maintained saws, rigging, chippers and trucks.
- Operated and maintained diesel equipment and small-engine tools; managed preventive maintenance schedules.

Diesel Mechanic / Heavy Equipment Technician — Rebuilt semi diesel engines; diagnostics and repair on heavy equipment.
Lead Framer - Commercial Construction — Led framing crews on commercial projects including Walmart builds; blueprint reading, lifts, layout, safety.
Material Handler / Manufacturing Support — Wacker Neuson operations support: forklifts, cranes, SAP inventory and material flow.
CDL Driver — Regional tractor-trailer operations for Team Lindy Trucking.

SUPPORTING TECHNICAL WORK

Founder / Environmental Intelligence & Systems Designer

NviroGear LLC — Michigan | Recent

- Built environmental intelligence workflows combining public environmental records, parcel information, GIS layers, groundwater and well data, and contamination evidence into site-level decision support.
- Designed the Alice land and environmental intelligence system: traceable evidence, canonical records, map layers, public/private controls, reusable components.
- Developed data ingestion and normalization workflows for county parcel records, environmental datasets, well records and regulatory information; JSON/GeoJSON, schemas, APIs, web applications, cloud deployment.
- Applied AI as a build and research partner to prototype software, investigate problems, and document systems.
- Explored groundwater-gradient, contamination-proximity and property-intelligence methods; translated complex records into understandable reports and interactive maps.

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH

Independent research in acoustics, recording and frequency analysis: measuring how sound behaves in physical spaces, including overlap, separation, sensing and reproduction of complex signals. Field-tested methodology: document, measure, repeat. Kept as an active practice.

TECHNICAL

Pumps and pumping systems • Diesel engines and heavy equipment • Electrical panels and control troubleshooting • Mechanical diagnostics • Environmental monitoring and sampling • Blueprint and specification reading • GIS concepts and map layers • Data normalization and schema design • APIs, JSON/GeoJSON, web applications • AI-assisted prototyping

EDUCATION

Self-directed technical education; no traditional software or engineering degree. Built the skill base in the field and through independent study; learns unfamiliar systems by working them.